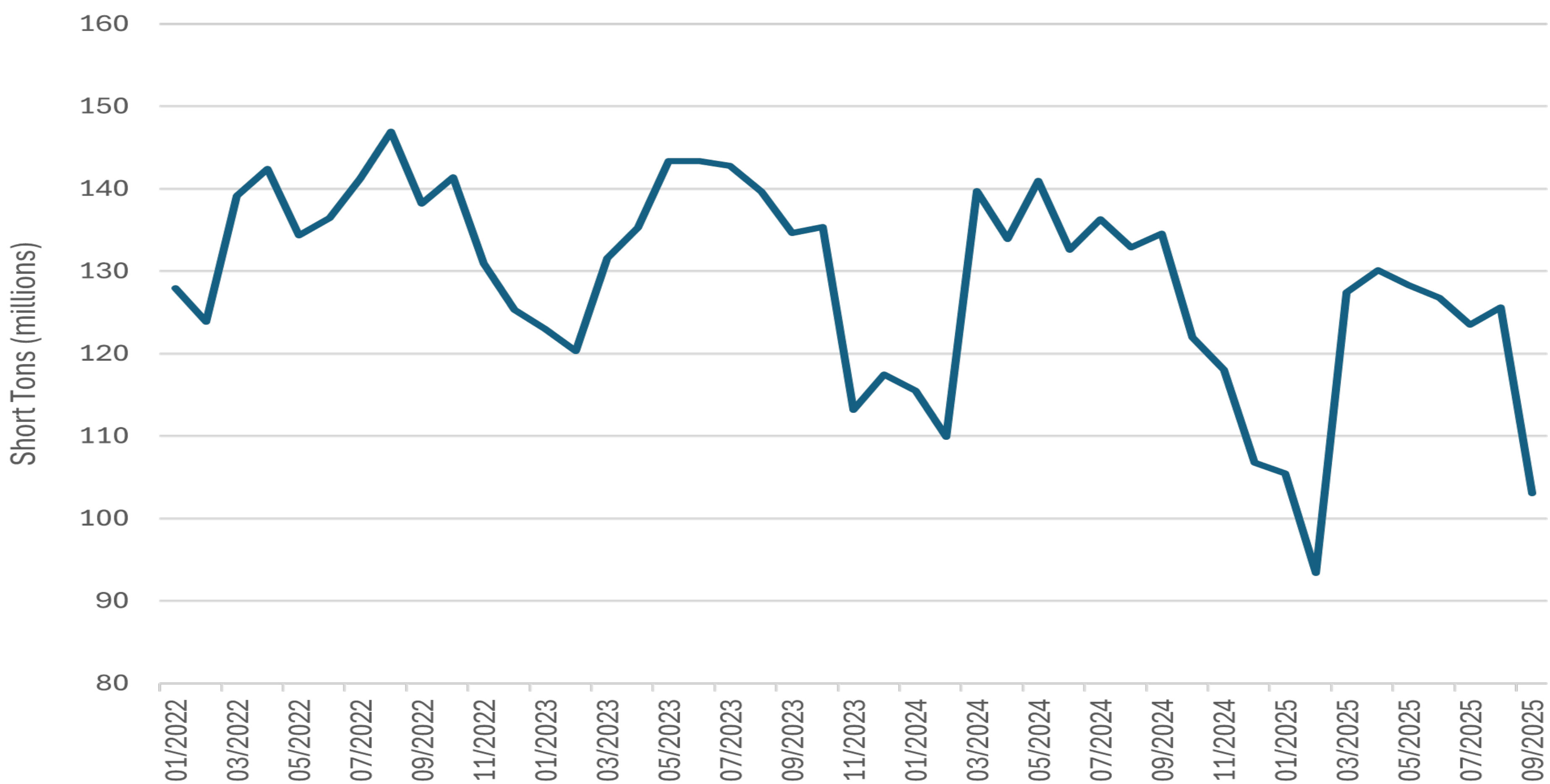

1. Background

Figure 24 displays a **time-series line chart** illustrating monthly U.S. waterborne tonnage from January 2022 through September 2025. The y-axis shows short tons (millions), ranging from approximately 80 to 160 million. The line exhibits recurring seasonal peaks (typically mid-year) and troughs (late-year), with notable dips in early 2024 and early 2025.

PASS

2. Text Contrast

Text labels use **white** against a black background, exceeding WCAG 4.5:1. The teal data line contrasts strongly with both the grid lines and the background. Contrast approximations: Estimated WCAG Contrast Ratios: • Teal line (#0A5C66 approx.) vs black background: ~4.8:1 • Grid lines (light gray) vs black: ~3.6:1 • Axis labels (white) vs black background: 12.6:1 All exceed minimum graphical contrast requirement (3:1).
PASS

3. Graphic (Line) Contrast

The single line is thick, high-contrast, and clearly distinguishable from the grid. Grid lines support trend interpretation without overpowering the data. No overlapping annotations reduce clarity.
PASS

4. Color-Blind Accessibility

Because only one data series is present, color-blind concerns are minimal. The line style (thickness + solid stroke) remains interpretable even without color perception.
PASS

5. OCR / Text Size

Axis labels, rotated date labels, and numeric scales are sufficiently large for OCR extraction. Rotation does not hinder machine readability since characters retain consistent baseline spacing.
PASS

6. Blur & DPI

The figure is crisp at current resolution. For congressional print applications, exporting a $\geq$300 DPI master ensures line and grid clarity.
PASS

7. Alt Text Recommendation

“ Line chart showing monthly U.S. waterborne tonnage from January 2022 through September 2025. Values range from roughly 110–150 million short tons in 2022, drop to near 120 million in early 2023, rise above 140 million mid-2023, decline sharply in early 2024 to near 110 million, then rise again before dipping in early 2025 and recovering toward mid-2025. Overall pattern shows repeated seasonal peaks and troughs with notable volatility in 2024–2025. ”

PASS